

Come Home To Your Body

5 daily rituals to return to your embodied intelligence and reclaim the self you buried under the noise



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You move through your days mentally capable, socially functional, and quietly hollow. Something in “ you is always slightly elsewhere. The body speaks and you override it with logic. The breath stays shallow. The heart signals what it needs and the mind finds a reason to dismiss it.

This is not a personal failing. It is what happens when we live from the neck up in a world that rewards it. These five practices are not a wellness routine. They are a doorway back. Short enough to do daily. Deep enough to change what you hear when you go quiet.

◆ PRACTICE ONE

Arrive: The Three-Breath Reset

01

Most people never fully arrive in their body because they never consciously cross the threshold between outer world and inner world. The Three-Breath Reset is a micro-ritual that does exactly that, and it borrows its real mechanism from one of the oldest teachings I know: the Vigyan Bhairav Tantra, a text of 112 techniques taught in Kashmir Shaivism centuries before anyone called this nervous system regulation. One of its instructions names the actual doorway: the pause inside the breath, not the breath itself.

When breath is all out and stopped of itself, or all in and stopped, in that universal pause, the small self vanishes. Ninety seconds is enough to find that pause three times.

How to do it:

- Sit or stand wherever you are. Close your eyes if it is safe to do so.
- First breath: inhale for four counts, exhale for six. When the exhale ends, wait. Don't rush the next inhale. Let there be a real gap before breath turns and comes back in. That gap is the technique, not the breath around it.
- Second breath: feel the weight of your body, buttocks on chair, feet on floor, hands resting. Name three points of contact aloud or internally.
- Third breath: place one hand on your sternum. Feel the warmth. At the top of the inhale, before it turns to go out, pause there too. Notice what is here, not what needs to be solved.
- Open your eyes. You have arrived.

Use this at the start of the morning, before any significant conversation, and before entering any sacred or ceremonial space. It's the same pause I ask a room to find before we begin any ceremony. You're just finding it for a room of one.

DO THIS

Set a phone alarm for 7am labelled "Arrive." Do the Three-Breath Reset, pause included, before you look at any screen. Do it for seven days and notice what changes in the quality of your first hour.

◆ PRACTICE TWO

Root: The Five-Minute Earth Ritual

02

The body disconnects when it does not feel safe, and the root chakra is where that safety registers first, before it ever becomes a thought. In the chakra teachings this work draws from, the root doesn't just sit at the base of your spine. It lives in the soles of your feet and the backs of your legs, wherever you're actually in contact with the ground. Safety in the nervous system is not conceptual. It is felt through sensation: heaviness, warmth, pressure, the reliable pull of gravity. Grounding is not a metaphor here. It is a physiological recalibration.

The practice:

- Barefoot if possible. Stand outside or on an uncarpeted floor.
- Bend your knees slightly. Feel the slight yield. This is your body accepting support.
- Press through all four corners of each foot: big toe mound, little toe mound, inner heel, outer heel.
- Imagine roots growing downward, not as fantasy, but as an invitation for your weight to drop fully.
- Breathe into your belly, not your chest. On every exhale, let whatever you've been carrying, a worry, a tightness, a feeling with nowhere to go, drain out through the soles of your feet into the

ground beneath you. Stay here for five minutes. Notice any resistance. That resistance is information.

If you practice any form of ceremonial or tantrik work, do this before you enter the space. It anchors you below the mental chatter and opens the channel for genuine presence. You can't offer, or receive, real depth from a body that hasn't landed yet.

◆ PRACTICE THREE

03

Listen: The Pleasure Inventory

Many people have been taught, explicitly or by omission, that pleasure is frivolous, dangerous, or selfish. In the sacred sexuality and temple work I've trained in for years, pleasure isn't a bonus feeling you get once the real work is done. It's treated as a sense organ: a direct signal from the body about what is life-giving and what is not, no less reliable than sight or hearing. Reclaiming it is not indulgence. It is a return to an ancient guidance system.

The training word for what's underneath this practice is simply sensing: letting the body register pleasure the way it registers pain, before the mind gets a chance to translate it into a story.

The Pleasure Inventory is a daily two-minute practice built on that same sensing. Keep a small notebook or a note on your phone. Instead of naming pleasure in general, try to catch it moving through a specific channel:

- Touch: one thing that felt genuinely good against your skin today. Sunlight, water, fabric, another person's hand, your own.
- Sound or taste: one thing you heard or tasted today that you actually noticed, rather than let pass through you unclaimed.
- Movement or stillness: one moment your body wanted to move, or wanted to stop, and you let it.

You are not performing gratitude. You are training a sense organ that atrophies from disuse, the same way a muscle does. Where attention goes, aliveness follows.

DO THIS

Tonight before sleep, write three entries in your Pleasure Inventory, one per channel. Do not filter for whether they are "significant enough." The body does not rank its wisdom by channel. Neither should you.

Release: The Somatic Shake

Animals release stress through involuntary shaking, a full-body tremor that discharges the exact muscular activation a threat response builds. Humans learned to suppress it, and what the body could not shake out, it stored, often in the psoas, the deep hip muscle most directly wired to your fight-or-flight response. The somatic shake is one of the most direct tools for moving what has been held. It works through the body's own tremor mechanism, and it requires no particular skill or spiritual vocabulary, only permission.

Trauma-release practitioners build this into three stages: activating the tremor, letting it run its full course, and then actually settling afterward, rather than stopping cold. Most people skip that last part and wonder why they still feel wired an hour later.

How to practice:

- Stand with feet hip-width apart, knees soft. Begin to gently bounce through the knees.
- Let the bounce travel upward. Let the belly soften. Let the arms hang loose and begin to vibrate with the movement.
- If sound wants to come, give it a shape instead of leaving it vague. Try one of the Taoist Six Healing Sounds: a "shhh" on the exhale for the liver, a "haww" from the chest for the heart, a low "chuwaay" for the kidneys. You don't need to know which organ you're addressing. The sound itself is the release.
- Continue for five to ten minutes. The key quality is surrender: you are not performing shaking, you are allowing it.
- Settle. This is the part most people skip. Slow the movement gradually rather than stopping outright, then stand quietly for two full minutes. Notice what has shifted.

This practice is particularly useful before integration sessions, after Kambô or plant medicine work, or on any day where you notice yourself holding tension without knowing why.

Integrate: The Evening Body Scan

Integration is where the real work happens, and it rarely happens in the ceremony or the peak moment. It happens in the ordinary evening after, when you choose to sit with what moved through you rather than consuming something to avoid it. This five-minute body scan closes the day consciously, and it borrows a small addition from chakra-based meditation that makes "just noticing" something you can actually feel: touch plus breath, together, at every stop.

The practice:

- Lie down. Close your eyes. Begin at the top of your head and move slowly downward: skull, jaw, throat, chest, belly, hips, legs, feet.
- At each area, rest two fingers there if you can reach it, or simply direct your breath to the spot if you can't. Breathe in and out through that point of contact for a few full breaths before moving to the next. Temperature. Tension. Sensation. Numbness is also information.
- When you find an area holding something, stay longer. Do not try to fix or explain it. Just breathe under your own touch and acknowledge: "I feel this here."
- Before sleep, ask your body one question: "What does this day want me to know?" Wait quietly, hand resting wherever it landed last. What comes first, before the mind edits it, is often the truest answer.

DO THIS

Do the Evening Body Scan tonight, touch and all. Set a seven-minute timer. Afterwards, write one sentence, whatever arose first. Keep it. Read it in the morning. Notice if anything has clarified by then.

Ready to go deeper than a daily practice?

These five rituals are the foundation. The real work happens in circle, in ceremony, and in devoted containers that hold you accountable to the full truth of who you are. Medicine Within offers Kambô ceremony, tantrik temples, sacred feminine embodiment, and one-to-one work, in Amsterdam and beyond.

Explore Medicine Within

"This experience softened layers in me that I didn't even realize I was holding. The next day I found myself relating from a much softer, more surrendered, and more heart-open space."

— Charlotte Denton, on working with Sandi

A NOTE FROM SANDI



I'm Sandi, founder of Medicine Within, based in Amsterdam. Everything in this guide comes out of my own root training: embodied tantra, temple facilitation, and Kambô, all of it led by the nervous system first, because the body has to feel safe before any of the rest can land. These five rituals are the ones I actually return to myself.